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CHAPTER 1

ARRIVAL OF EUROPEANS IN INDIA (Part–3)

The English in India

Introduction

After the Portuguese and the Dutch, the **English** came to India for trade. They started as traders but later became the most powerful European power in India. Through the **East India Company**, they slowly expanded their trade and finally established political control over India.

Formation of the East India Company

To trade with Asian countries, English merchants formed a trading company.

Important Facts

- In **1599**, a group of English merchants formed the **Merchant Adventurers**.
- On **31 December 1600**, **Queen Elizabeth I** granted a Royal Charter.
- The company was named the **East India Company (EIC)**.
- The company received the exclusive right to trade with East Indies.

Exam Fact: 31 December 1600 → East India Company was established.

William Hawkins

The English wanted permission from the Mughal Emperor to trade in India.

Important Facts

- **Captain William Hawkins** reached **Surat** in **1608**.
- He came on the ship **Hector**.
- He carried a letter from **King James I** to **Emperor Jahangir**.
- Hawkins knew the **Turki (Turkish)** language.

- Jahangir appointed him as a **Mansabdar of 400**.

Exam Fact: William Hawkins is known as the **first English representative** at Jahangir's court.

First English Factory in India

After receiving permission, the English established trading centres.

Important Facts

- **1613** – First permanent English factory established at **Surat (Gujarat)**.
- It was established under **Thomas Aldworth**.

Exam Fact: First English factory → **Surat (1613)**.

Sir Thomas Roe

The English wanted stronger relations with the Mughal Empire.

Important Facts

- Arrived at Jahangir's court in **1615**.
- Came as the ambassador of **King James I**.
- Helped the English secure trading privileges in India.

Expansion of English Trade

The English gradually opened factories in different parts of India.

Important Facts

- **1616** – First factory in South India at **Masulipatnam**.
- **1632** – Received the **Golden Farman** from the **Sultan of Golconda**.
- **1633** – First factory in Eastern India established at **Hariharpur (Balasore, Odisha)**.

Bombay Comes Under the English

Bombay later became an important English settlement.

Important Facts

- In **1662**, **Bombay** was given to **King Charles II** by Portugal as dowry.
- Charles II married **Catherine of Braganza**, a Portuguese princess.
- In **1668**, Bombay was leased to the **East India Company** for an annual rent of **£10**.
- **Gerald Aungier** became the first Governor of Bombay under the Company.

Exam Fact: Bombay became an English possession through marriage, not war.

English in Bengal

The English gradually expanded their trade into Bengal.

Important Facts

- In **1651**, **Shah Shuja**, Governor of Bengal, allowed the English to trade after payment of **Rs. 3,000** annually.
- **William Hedges** became the first English Agent and Governor in Bengal.
- English established a factory at **Hooghly**.

Foundation of Calcutta

The English established their strongest settlement in Bengal.

Important Facts

- In **1698**, **Job Charnock** obtained the zamindari of:
 - **Sutanuti**
 - **Gobindapur**
 - **Kalikata**
- In **1700**, these villages were developed into **Fort William**.

Exam Fact: Job Charnock is regarded as the founder of Calcutta.

Merger of the English Companies

Two English companies competed for trade in India.

Important Facts

- A rival English company was formed after the **Glorious Revolution (1688)**.
- **Sir William Norris** visited Aurangzeb's court.
- In **1708**, both companies merged.
- New name:
United Company of Merchants of England Trading to the East Indies.
- The company continued till **1858**.

Farrukhsiyar's Farman (1717)

This was one of the biggest successes of the East India Company.

Important Facts

- In **1715**, **John Surman** led an English mission to Emperor **Farrukhsiyar**.
- In **1717**, Farrukhsiyar issued **three Farmans**.
- These Farmans gave important trading privileges in:
 - Bengal
 - Gujarat
 - Hyderabad
- These Farmans are called the **Magna Carta of the East India Company**.

Exam Fact: 1717 Farman = Magna Carta of the East India Company.

Important Personalities

Personality	Contribution
Queen Elizabeth I	Granted Royal Charter to the East India Company
King James I	Sent William Hawkins and Sir Thomas Roe
William Hawkins	First English representative at Jahangir's court
Thomas Aldworth	Established first English factory at Surat
Sir Thomas Roe	Ambassador to Jahangir
Charles II	Received Bombay from Portugal
Catherine of Braganza	Portuguese princess; Bombay came as dowry
Gerald Aungier	First Governor of Bombay
Shah Shuja	Allowed English trade in Bengal
William Hedges	First English Agent in Bengal

Job Charnock	Founder of Calcutta
Sir William Norris	Ambassador to Aurangzeb
John Surman	Led mission to Farrukhsiyar
Farrukhsiyar	Issued the Farman of 1717

Important Places

Place	Importance
Surat	First permanent English factory (1613)
Masulipatnam	First English factory in South India
Hariharpur (Balasore)	First English factory in Eastern India
Bombay	Given to Charles II in 1662; leased to EIC in 1668
Hooghly	First English trading centre in Bengal
Fort William (Calcutta)	Main English settlement in Bengal

Important Farmans

Name	Year	Importance
Golden Farman	1632	Trading privileges from Sultan of Golconda
Farrukhsiyar's Farman	1717	Magna Carta of the East India Company

Important Years

Year	Event
1599	Merchant Adventurers formed
1600	East India Company established
1608	William Hawkins reached Surat
1613	First English factory at Surat
1615	Sir Thomas Roe reached Jahangir's court
1616	First factory in South India (Masulipatnam) 1
1632	Golden Farman
1633	First factory in Eastern India (Hariharpur)
1651	English received trading rights in Bengal
1662	Bombay received as dowry
1668	Bombay leased to East India Company
1698	Job Charnock acquired three villages
1700	Fort William established

1708	Two English companies merged
1717	Farrukhsiyar's Farman

Frequently Confused Facts

Question	Correct Answer
East India Company established	1600
First English factory	Surat (1613)
First factory in South India	Masulipatnam
First factory in Eastern India	Hariharpur (Balasore)
Founder of Calcutta	Job Charnock
First Governor of Bombay	Gerald Aungier
Golden Farman issued by	Sultan of Golconda
Magna Carta of East India Company	Farrukhsiyar's Farman (1717)
First English representative at Jahangir's court	William Hawkins
Ambassador to Jahangir	Sir Thomas Roe

Previous Year Exam Focus

- East India Company (1600)
- William Hawkins
- Sir Thomas Roe
- First English factory
- Bombay as dowry
- Job Charnock
- Fort William
- Farrukhsiyar's Farman
- Golden Farman
- Magna Carta of the East India Company

Expected MCQ Areas

- East India Company
- Royal Charter
- William Hawkins
- Sir Thomas Roe
- First factories
- Bombay
- Job Charnock
- Farrukhsiyar
- Golden Farman
- Fort William

Quick Revision

- Merchant Adventurers → **1599**
- East India Company → **1600**
- William Hawkins → **1608**
- Ship → **Hector**
- Jahangir → **Hawkins**
- First Factory → **Surat (1613)**
- Sir Thomas Roe → **1615**
- South India Factory → **Masulipatnam**
- Golden Farman → **1632**
- East India Factory → **Hariharpur**
- Bengal Trade → **1651**
- Bombay Dowry → **1662**
- Bombay to EIC → **1668**
- Job Charnock → **1698**
- Fort William → **1700**
- Companies Merged → **1708**
- John Surman → **1715**
- Farrukhsiyar Farman → **1717**
- Magna Carta → **1717 Farman**
- Founder of Calcutta → **Job Charnock**

Memory Tricks

Hawkins = Hector

Hawkins came on Hector.

(H → H)

Surat = Start

Surat = Start of English trade in India

Remember:

First English Factory → Surat

1717 = Lucky Farman

Think:

1717 = Luck changed for the East India Company

This Farman is called the **Magna Carta of the East India Company**.

Exam Summary (2-Minute Revision)

- **East India Company → 1600**
- **William Hawkins → 1608, Ship Hector, Court of Jahangir**
- **First English Factory → Surat (1613)**
- **Sir Thomas Roe → 1615**
- **Golden Farman → 1632**
- **First Factory in East India → Hariharpur (1633)**
- **Bombay → Dowry in 1662, leased to EIC in 1668**
- **Job Charnock → Founder of Calcutta**
- **Fort William → 1700**
- **Farrukhsiyar's Farman (1717) → Magna Carta of the East India Company**
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